

SGIA 2341 Research Project 2026-2027

Gender, Quotas and Political Representation

Kevin Wu

Tutor: Kevin Wu

Email: tse-luen.wu@durham.ac.uk

Office / Office hours: IM 204 Mondays 11:00 AM - 12:30 PM

Seminars: Michaelmas, two hours, fortnightly · Epiphany, one hour, fortnightly

Project Overview

In most of the world's parliaments, men still make up the majority of legislators. More than one hundred countries have adopted gender quotas, generating a large literature on whether increasing women's representation changes what governments do. But quotas do more than alter the number of women in office. By intervening in candidate selection, they also shape *which* women enter politics, with potentially important consequences for representation and policymaking.

This seminar examines gender quotas through that broader lens. Across five sessions, we trace a causal chain from the barriers that limit women's entry into politics, through the party gatekeepers who determine who appears on the ballot, to the consequences of women's representation for legislative behaviour and public policy. At each stage, we ask both whether the proposed mechanism holds and under what institutional conditions it does so. Drawing on comparative evidence from around the world, the course also pays particular attention to the research designs scholars use to identify the causal effects of electoral institutions and gender quotas.

No prior knowledge of gender politics is required, and projects need not be quantitative. Students interested in candidate selection, political recruitment, legislative behaviour, electoral institutions, or representation more broadly will find the framework portable well beyond the question of gender.

Project Aim, Structure and Assessment

Aim

The seminar has three goals. The first is to introduce students to the theoretical and empirical literature on gender and political representation. The second is to develop the

capacity to engage critically with that literature and to identify where its claims remain unsettled. The third is to equip students with the conceptual and methodological tools to design and carry out a research project of their own.

Structure

Michaelmas (Seminars 1–5, two hours, fortnightly). Each session pairs a substantive topic with one component of the research process. Required readings include a methods chapter drawn from the module’s shared spine (Halperin & Heath, and Booth et al.). By the end of Seminar 5 you should have a draft of the project design you submit at the end of term.

Epiphany (Seminars 6–10, one hour, fortnightly). Peer-feedback sessions. Students present the state of their projects and critique each other’s work. Reading, critiquing and responding to others’ research is itself a research skill, and the seminars are structured to develop it.

Assessment

The module is assessed by a 4,500-word research project, worth 80%, and a 500-word reflective learning log, worth 20%. Both are submitted on Blackboard no later than 11.59 a.m. on 04/05/2027. The module handbook gives the deadlines and the formatting requirements.

In addition, you will submit a 1,500-word project plan at the end of Michaelmas term.

Research Project (4,500 words, 80%)

The research project should contain:

- The research question or questions that your project will answer.
- An analysis of existing literature that relates to your research question or questions.
- A statement on how the research project contributes to this literature.
- A description of theories or theoretical frameworks used, making it clear how these have helped in answering the research question or questions.
- A description of the method used to answer the research question.
- An analysis that provides an answer to your research question or questions.

Additional guidance for this seminar group. The module handbook notes that seminar leaders may add to its requirements. For projects on gender and political representation I also expect:

- A statement of what you expected to find and where those expectations come from in the theory.
- A discussion of the project’s limitations and what they mean for what you can claim.
- A consideration of any ethical issues raised by the project, including your own position as a researcher where that is relevant, and how you have addressed them.

Reflective Learning Log (500 words, 20%)

The reflective learning log should contain:

- A discussion of your expectations at the start of the assessment.
- An explanation of what you have learned through working on the assessment, and how this learning has informed and improved your final submission.
- A reflection on what was harder than expected and what was easier than expected.
- A discussion of the learning points you will take forward for similar assessments in the future.

Finding Relevant Literature and Data

Finding the literature

Conducting a literature review is a skill, and the fastest way into an unfamiliar field is not to read forwards from a textbook but to work outwards from a recent review article. Several are assigned in the seminar reading lists that follow, and each will show you how specialists organise the field and which works they treat as load-bearing.

From there, work in two directions. Look at what your review article cites. Then search each key work in Web of Science and see who has cited it since. Following a citation network forwards and backwards will find you more relevant material, faster, than any keyword search.

Databases recommend:

- **Web of Science** and **Scopus**
- **JSTOR**
- **Litmaps**
- **Google Scholar**

Finding the data

Representation and quotas

- Inter-Parliamentary Union, **Parline**: women in national parliaments, current and historical
- International IDEA, **Gender Quotas Database**: quota type, design and sanctions by country
- **V-Dem**: Women's Political Empowerment Index and component indicators
- **QAROT** (Quota Adoption and Reform Over Time)
- UN Women, **Women in Politics** map

Candidates and legislators

- **Comparative Candidates Survey (CCS)**
- National electoral commission candidate records (e.g. the UK Electoral Commission, or India's ECI)

- Parliamentary records: Hansard (UK), and equivalent debate and bill databases elsewhere

Michaelmas Term

Seminar 1: The Puzzle of Under-Representation / Formulating a Research Question

In this seminar, I will go over the structure of the seminar series, what is expected of you, and the assessments. Afterwards, we will turn to the puzzle that organises the module. We will begin by separating supply-side explanations, which locate the problem in who comes forward, from demand-side explanations, which locate it in who gets picked, and we will ask what evidence could distinguish between them. We will then work through one article in detail, not to master its methods but to see how a strong research question is built and how an argument is assembled. We will also discuss how to find and formulate a research question of your own.

Required readings

- Norris, P. and Lovenduski, J. 1995. *Political Recruitment: Gender, Race and Class in the British Parliament* (Ch. 1 and 6). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Lawless, J. L. and Fox, R. L. 2025. *It Takes More Than a Candidate: Why Women Don't Run for Office*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 2–3). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Halperin, S. and Heath, O. 2020. “Asking Questions: How to Find and Formulate Research Questions.” In *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 4). Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Chattopadhyay, R. and Duflo, E. 2004. “Women as Policy Makers: Evidence from a Randomized Policy Experiment in India.” *Econometrica* 72 (5): 1409–1443.

Seminar questions

1. Is under-representation a supply problem or a demand problem? What evidence would distinguish them?
2. “There are too few women in politics”: is this a research question? If not, what would turn it into one?
3. Lawless and Fox locate the gap in political ambition. Is ambition a cause or a consequence of the barriers women face?
4. Is “why are there fewer women in politics?” the same question as “why are there fewer women in office than in the professions that lead to office?” Which one are Lawless and Fox actually asking, and what does the narrowing buy them?

Anatomy of an article: Chattopadhyay and Duflo (2004)

Anatomy questions

1. What is the central research question, and why could it not be answered by comparing councils that happened to have women leaders?

2. What does the randomisation buy the authors? What would they have been unable to claim without it?
3. The effects differ across the two states studied. Does that strengthen or weaken the argument?
4. The outcome is public goods provision. What else might have changed that this design cannot see?

Supplementary readings

Ambition, recruitment and the supply side

- Bernhard, R., Shames, S. and Teele, D. L. 2021. “To Emerge? Breadwinning, Motherhood, and Women’s Decisions to Run for Office.” *American Political Science Review* 115 (2): 379–394.
- Piscopo, J. M. and Kenny, M. 2020. “Rethinking the Ambition Gap: Gender and Candidate Emergence in Comparative Perspective.” *European Journal of Politics and Gender* 3 (1): 3–10.

The demand side: voters and gatekeepers

- Krook, M. L. 2010. “Why Are Fewer Women than Men Elected? Gender and the Dynamics of Candidate Selection.” *Political Studies Review* 8 (2): 155–168.
- Teele, D. L., Kalla, J. and Rosenbluth, F. 2018. “The Ties That Double Bind: Social Roles and Women’s Underrepresentation in Politics.” *American Political Science Review* 112 (3): 525–541.
- Schwarz, S. and Coppock, A. 2022. “What Have We Learned about Gender from Candidate Choice Experiments? A Meta-Analysis of Sixty-Seven Factorial Survey Experiments.” *Journal of Politics* 84 (2): 655–668.

Global patterns

- Paxton, P., Hughes, M. M. and Barnes, T. D. 2020. *Women, Politics, and Power: A Global Perspective*, 4th ed. Lanham: Rowman & Littlefield.
- Jalalzai, F. 2013. *Shattered, Cracked, or Firmly Intact? Women and the Executive Glass Ceiling Worldwide*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Inter-Parliamentary Union, *Women in National Parliaments* (Parline database).

Readings on research questions

- Booth, W. C., Colomb, G. G., Williams, J. M., Bizup, J. and Fitzgerald, W. T. 2016. *The Craft of Research*, 4th ed. (Ch. 3–4). Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Seminar 2: Does Descriptive Representation Matter? / Theories, Concepts and Hypotheses

The previous seminar left open a question it did not answer: whether it matters *who* holds office, as distinct from how many. In this seminar, we will engage with the conceptual apparatus that the field uses to address it. We will begin with Pitkin’s distinction between standing for and acting for, and ask whether the two can be separated empirically. We

will then turn to Mansbridge’s defence of descriptive representation and to the conditions she attaches to it, since the defence is a contingent one. We will conclude by examining evidence on whether quotas change what legislatures do, and the difficulty of measuring “substantive representation” at all. We will also discuss theories and concepts, and how to pin down the central concept of your own project.

Required readings

- Pitkin, H. F. 1967. *The Concept of Representation* (Ch. 4 and 6). Berkeley: University of California Press.
- Mansbridge, J. 1999. “Should Blacks Represent Blacks and Women Represent Women? A Contingent ‘Yes.’” *Journal of Politics* 61 (3): 628–657.
- Franceschet, S. and Piscopo, J. M. 2008. “Gender Quotas and Women’s Substantive Representation: Lessons from Argentina.” *Politics & Gender* 4 (3): 393–425.
- Halperin, S. and Heath, O. 2020. “Theories and How to Apply Them.” In *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 5). Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Seminar questions

1. Pitkin distinguishes *standing for* from *acting for*. Are they empirically separable, and how would you separate them?
2. Mansbridge’s “yes” is contingent. On what? Are those conditions met in the case you are interested in?
3. Franceschet and Piscopo find that quotas can increase substantive representation while damaging women legislators’ perceived legitimacy. Is that a cost of quotas or a cost of the backlash to them?
4. How would you *measure* substantive representation? Bills introduced? Speeches? Votes? Policy outcomes? What does each miss?

Supplementary readings

The theoretical foundations

- Phillips, A. 1995. *The Politics of Presence: The Political Representation of Gender, Ethnicity, and Race*. Oxford: Clarendon Press.
- Young, I. M. 2000. *Inclusion and Democracy*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Dovi, S. 2002. “Preferable Descriptive Representatives: Will Just Any Woman, Black, or Latino Do?” *American Political Science Review* 96 (4): 729–743.

Testing the link

- Wängnerud, L. 2009. “Women in Parliaments: Descriptive and Substantive Representation.” *Annual Review of Political Science* 12: 51–69.
- Clayton, A. 2021. “How Do Electoral Gender Quotas Affect Policy?” *Annual Review of Political Science* 24: 235–252.
- Clayton, A. and Zetterberg, P. 2018. “Quota Shocks: Electoral Gender Quotas and Government Spending Priorities Worldwide.” *Journal of Politics* 80 (3): 916–932.

- O'Brien, D. Z. and Piscopo, J. M. 2019. "The Impact of Women in Parliament." In Franceschet, S., Krook, M. L. and Tan, N. (eds) *The Palgrave Handbook of Women's Political Rights*, 53–72. London: Palgrave Macmillan.

Where the link breaks

- Weeks, A. C. and Masala, F. 2023. "Still 'the Domain of Men?' Gender Quotas and Women's Inclusion in Local Politics in Italy." *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 48 (3): 503–534.
- Zetterberg, P. 2008. "The Downside of Gender Quotas? Institutional Constraints on Women in Mexican State Legislatures." *Parliamentary Affairs* 61 (3): 442–460.
- Beaman, L., Duflo, E., Pande, R. and Topalova, P. 2012. "Female Leadership Raises Aspirations and Educational Attainment for Girls: A Policy Experiment in India." *Science* 335 (6068): 582–586.

Seminar 3: Can Institutions Fix It? Quotas and Electoral Rules / Research Design and Causal Inference

Having asked whether it matters who holds office, we now ask whether institutions can change who holds it. In this seminar, we will examine gender quotas. We will begin with the variety of quota designs (reserved seats, legislated candidate quotas, voluntary party quotas, with and without placement mandates and sanctions) and why the distinctions matter for what quotas achieve. We will then turn to the problem of establishing that a quota caused anything at all, rather than arriving in countries that were already changing. We will conclude by examining the designs researchers have used to address this, since quotas are often assigned by thresholds or lotteries and are therefore unusually well suited to credible identification. We will also discuss how to choose a research design appropriate to your own question.

Required readings

- Krook, M. L. 2009. *Quotas for Women in Politics: Gender and Candidate Selection Reform Worldwide* (Ch. 1–2). Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Schwindt-Bayer, L. A. 2009. "Making Quotas Work: The Effect of Gender Quota Laws on the Election of Women." *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 34 (1): 5–28.
- Bhavnani, R. R. 2009. "Do Electoral Quotas Work after They Are Withdrawn? Evidence from a Natural Experiment in India." *American Political Science Review* 103 (1): 23–35.
- Halperin, S. and Heath, O. 2020. "Research Design." In *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 6). Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Seminar questions

1. Why can we not simply compare countries with quotas to countries without them?
2. Bhavnani asks whether quota effects persist after the quota is removed. Why is that a better question than "do quotas work?"
3. Reserved seats, candidate quotas and voluntary party quotas are all called "quotas". Should they be studied as one thing?

4. What exactly does a threshold-based design identify? To what population does the estimate generalise?

Supplementary readings

Quota design and effectiveness

- Dahlerup, D. and Leyenaar, M. (eds) 2013. *Breaking Male Dominance in Old Democracies*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Paxton, P. and Hughes, M. M. 2015. “The Increasing Effectiveness of National Gender Quotas, 1990–2010.” *Legislative Studies Quarterly* 40 (3): 331–362.
- Hughes, M. M., Paxton, P. and Krook, M. L. 2017. “Gender Quotas for Legislatures and Corporate Boards.” *Annual Review of Sociology* 43: 331–352.
- Tripp, A. M. and Kang, A. 2008. “The Global Impact of Quotas: On the Fast Track to Increased Female Legislative Representation.” *Comparative Political Studies* 41 (3): 338–361.

Causal designs applied to gender and office

- Clots-Figueras, I. 2011. “Women in Politics: Evidence from the Indian States.” *Journal of Public Economics* 95 (7–8): 664–690.
- Ferreira, F. and Gyourko, J. 2014. “Does Gender Matter for Political Leadership? The Case of U.S. Mayors.” *Journal of Public Economics* 112: 24–39.
- Bagues, M. and Campa, P. 2021. “Can Gender Quotas in Candidate Lists Empower Women? Evidence from a Regression Discontinuity Design.” *Journal of Public Economics* 194: 104315.

Research design and inference

- Dunning, T. 2012. *Natural Experiments in the Social Sciences: A Design-Based Approach*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Seawright, J. and Gerring, J. 2008. “Case Selection Techniques in Case Study Research: A Menu of Qualitative and Quantitative Options.” *Political Research Quarterly* 61 (2): 294–308.
- Beach, D. and Pedersen, R. B. 2019. *Process-Tracing Methods: Foundations and Guidelines*, 2nd ed. Ann Arbor: University of Michigan Press.

Seminar 4: Who Gets Selected, and Who Gets Displaced? / Data and Measurement

The previous seminar treated quotas as rules that raise a number. In this seminar, we will look at what happens inside the parties that have to comply with them. We will begin with candidate selection as a process: who selects, by what method, and against what criteria. We will then examine three studies of what happens when a quota binds, asking who is displaced, who enters, and at whose expense, in Sweden, Ireland and India. A quota changes the gender requirement for a nomination, but it does not change the other things parties look for, such as name recognition, campaign finance and local organisational support. Where the pool of women who already hold those assets is thin, parties adapt in ways the quota’s designers did not intend. We will conclude by asking whether the three

studies describe one phenomenon or several. We will also discuss what counts as data, and how each study decided who belonged in which category.

Required readings

- Hazan, R. Y. and Rahat, G. 2010. *Democracy within Parties: Candidate Selection Methods and Their Political Consequences* (Ch. 1–2). Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Besley, T., Folke, O., Persson, T. and Rickne, J. 2017. “Gender Quotas and the Crisis of the Mediocre Man: Theory and Evidence from Sweden.” *American Economic Review* 107 (8): 2204–2242.
- Folke, O., Rickne, J. and Smith, D. M. 2021. “Gender and Dynastic Political Selection.” *Comparative Political Studies* 54 (2): 339–371.
- Karekurve-Ramachandra, V. and Lee, A. 2020. “Do Gender Quotas Hurt Less Privileged Groups? Evidence from India.” *American Journal of Political Science* 64 (4): 757–772.
- Halperin, S. and Heath, O. 2020. “What Is Data?” In *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 7). Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Seminar questions

1. Besley et al. find that quotas displaced mediocre men rather than competent ones. What does that imply about who was being selected before?
2. Folke, Rickne and Smith attribute dynastic entry to voters overcoming uncertainty about women candidates. What would the same pattern look like if parties, not voters, were doing the selecting, and how would you tell the two apart?
3. Family ties in Sweden and Ireland, caste in India. Are these two findings the same phenomenon in different clothing, or two different mechanisms?
4. If a quota reliably advantages the already-advantaged women in a society, is that an argument against quotas, an argument for designing them differently, or neither?
5. What kind of data does each study require, and what did its authors have to be able to observe? What questions could you *not* ask if that were the only data available to you?

Supplementary readings

Selection, gatekeeping and electoral assets

- Norris, P. and Lovenduski, J. 1995. *Political Recruitment: Gender, Race and Class in the British Parliament*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Carey, J. M. and Shugart, M. S. 1995. “Incentives to Cultivate a Personal Vote: A Rank Ordering of Electoral Formulas.” *Electoral Studies* 14 (4): 417–439.
- Cheng, C. and Tavits, M. 2011. “Informal Influences in Selecting Female Political Candidates.” *Political Research Quarterly* 64 (2): 460–471.
- Lawless, J. L. and Fox, R. L. 2025. *It Takes More Than a Candidate: Why Women Don’t Run for Office*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 5, “Gender, Party, and Political Recruitment”). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

- Weeks, A. C. 2018. “Why Are Gender Quota Laws Adopted by Men? The Role of Inter- and Intraparty Competition.” *Comparative Political Studies* 51 (14): 1935–1973.
- O’Brien, D. Z. 2015. “Rising to the Top: Gender, Political Performance, and Party Leadership in Parliamentary Democracies.” *American Journal of Political Science* 59 (4): 1022–1039.
- Wiliarty, S. E. 2010. *The CDU and the Politics of Gender in Germany: Bringing Women to the Party*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Weeks, A. C., Meguid, B. M., Kittilson, M. C. and Coffé, H. 2023. “When Do Männerparteien Elect Women? Radical Right Populist Parties and Strategic Descriptive Representation.” *American Political Science Review* 117 (2): 421–438.
- Meserve, S. A., Pemstein, D. and Bernhard, W. T. 2020. “Gender, Incumbency and Party List Nominations.” *British Journal of Political Science* 50 (1): 1–15.

Measurement

- Adcock, R. and Collier, D. 2001. “Measurement Validity: A Shared Standard for Qualitative and Quantitative Research.” *American Political Science Review* 95 (3): 529–546.
- Goertz, G. 2020. *Social Science Concepts and Measurement*, rev. ed. (Ch. 1–3). Princeton: Princeton University Press.

Seminar 5: Backlash, Legitimacy and Violence / Putting Your Research Project Together

So far we have asked who reaches office. In this seminar, we turn to what happens once they are there. We will begin by asking which women are represented when women are represented, since quotas do not distribute their benefits evenly among them. We will then examine what citizens infer from the composition of a political body, and whether legitimacy is a reason for descriptive representation independent of what representatives do. We will conclude with the costs of holding office, in the form of harassment and violence, alongside evidence that exposure to women leaders reduces bias, a finding that sits uneasily beside those costs. In the second half, we will workshop your project designs before you submit them, and discuss research ethics, and we will consider how a project should handle findings that complicate the story it set out to tell.

Required readings

- Hughes, M. M. 2011. “Intersectionality, Quotas, and Minority Women’s Political Representation Worldwide.” *American Political Science Review* 105 (3): 604–620.
- Clayton, A., O’Brien, D. Z. and Piscopo, J. M. 2019. “All Male Panels? Representation and Democratic Legitimacy.” *American Journal of Political Science* 63 (1): 113–129.
- Krook, M. L. 2020. *Violence against Women in Politics* (Ch. 1–2). Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Beaman, L., Chattopadhyay, R., Duflo, E., Pande, R. and Topalova, P. 2009. “Powerful Women: Does Exposure Reduce Bias?” *Quarterly Journal of Economics* 124 (4): 1497–1540.
- Booth, W. C. et al. 2016. “Planning and Drafting.” In *The Craft of Research*, 4th ed. (Ch. 12). Chicago: University of Chicago Press.

Seminar questions

1. Hughes argues that women are not a homogeneous group. What follows for how quotas should be designed, and for how their effects should be measured?
2. Krook documents violence and harassment as a systematic feature of women's political participation rather than an incidental one. What does that imply for the supply-side explanations we met in Seminar 1?
3. Beaman et al. find that exposure to women leaders reduces bias. Krook finds that visibility invites violence. Can both be true? What would settle it?
4. Clayton, O'Brien and Piscopo ask what citizens infer from an all-male body. Is legitimacy a reason for descriptive representation independent of what representatives actually do?
5. What ethical issues would arise if your project involved interviewing women politicians about harassment, or handling data on individuals' family relationships?

Supplementary readings

Intersectionality and distributional effects

- Celis, K., Childs, S., Kantola, J. and Krook, M. L. 2014. "Constituting Women's Interests through Representative Claims." *Politics & Gender* 10 (2): 149–174.
- Holmsten, S. S., Moser, R. G. and Slosar, M. C. 2010. "Do Ethnic Parties Exclude Women?" *Comparative Political Studies* 43 (10): 1179–1201.
- Celis, K. and Childs, S. 2012. "The Substantive Representation of Women: What to Do with Conservative Claims?" *Political Studies* 60 (1): 213–225.

What women in office can actually do

- Barnes, T. D. 2016. *Gendering Legislative Behavior: Institutional Constraints and Collaboration*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Childs, S. and Krook, M. L. 2009. "Analyzing Women's Substantive Representation: From Critical Mass to Critical Actors." *Government and Opposition* 44 (2): 125–145.
- Weldon, S. L. 2002. "Beyond Bodies: Institutional Sources of Representation for Women in Democratic Policymaking." *Journal of Politics* 64 (4): 1153–1174.
- Burnet, J. E. 2011. "Women Have Found Respect: Gender Quotas, Symbolic Representation, and Female Empowerment in Rwanda." *Politics & Gender* 7 (3): 303–334.

Qualitative approaches

- Franceschet, S., Krook, M. L. and Piscopo, J. M. (eds) 2012. *The Impact of Gender Quotas*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Kapiszewski, D., MacLean, L. M. and Read, B. L. 2015. *Field Research in Political Science: Practices and Principles*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Epiphany Term (Seminars 6–10, one hour, fortnightly)

Seminars 6 to 10 are for giving and receiving feedback on your individual projects. Your fellow students are a resource: reading and criticising someone else's work is one of the

fastest ways to see what is wrong with your own, and the feedback you give will advance your project as much as the feedback you get.

Each session runs the same way. Before the seminar, prepare written answers to the questions listed under that week. In the first part of the session you will work through those answers in small groups, giving each other advice. In the time remaining I will take up whatever the groups could not resolve. Every week opens with your research question and closes with where you have got stuck, so that the people commenting on one part of your project always know what the project as a whole is trying to do.

There is no new substantive reading this term. The reading you should be doing is the literature for your own project. A short list of methods readings for the whole term is given at the end of this section. Read the relevant item in the week it comes up if you need it.

Seminar 6: Research Question, Literature and Contribution

Prepare answers to the following:

- State the topic of your project in one sentence.
- Summarise the state of the literature on that topic: where is there consensus, where is there dispute, and what is missing?
- State your research question in one sentence.
- Explain how answering it contributes to the literature.
- Where are you with reviewing the literature and formulating your research question? What help do you need?

Seminar 7: Theoretical Framework and Hypotheses

Prepare answers to the following:

- State your research question in one sentence.
- Describe the theory or framework you are using, and say why it is the right one for this question.
- State your hypotheses, and show where each one comes from in the theory.
- Define your central concept. How will you know it when you see it?
- Where are you with developing your framework and hypotheses? What help do you need?

Seminar 8: Research Design, Methods and Data

Prepare answers to the following:

- State your research question in one sentence.
- Describe your research design and explain how it answers that question.
- Describe your cases or your data, and say why these rather than others.
- What could go wrong with this design, and what would you do about it?
- Where are you with choosing a design and selecting your cases or data? What help do you need?

Seminar 9: Analysis, Findings, Limitations

Prepare answers to the following:

- State your research question in one sentence.
- Describe how you are analysing your material.
- State your findings so far, and explain how they answer the question.
- State the limitations of your analysis and what they mean for what you can claim.
- Where are you with your analysis and its limitations? What help do you need?

Seminar 10: Overcoming Final Hurdles

Prepare answers to the following:

- State your research question in one sentence.
- Present the outline of your write-up, section by section.
- Which section is giving you the most trouble, and why?
- What have you had to abandon since your project design, and how does the project hold together without it?
- Where are you with writing up? What help do you need?

Methods readings for the Epiphany term

Read the relevant item in the week it comes up. None of these is long.

- Booth, W. C. et al. 2016. *The Craft of Research*, 4th ed. (Ch. 3–6). [Seminar 6]
- Gerring, J. 1999. “What Makes a Concept Good?” *Polity* 31 (3): 357–393. [Seminar 7]
- Goertz, G. 2020. *Social Science Concepts and Measurement*, rev. ed. (Ch. 1–3). Princeton: Princeton University Press. [Seminar 7]
- King, G., Keohane, R. O. and Verba, S. 1994. *Designing Social Inquiry: Scientific Inference in Qualitative Research* (Ch. 4). Princeton: Princeton University Press. [Seminar 8]
- Seawright, J. and Gerring, J. 2008. “Case Selection Techniques in Case Study Research: A Menu of Qualitative and Quantitative Options.” *Political Research Quarterly* 61 (2): 294–308. [Seminar 8]
- Halperin, S. and Heath, O. 2020. “Interpreting and Analysing Data.” In *Political Research: Methods and Practical Skills*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 14). Oxford: Oxford University Press. [Seminar 9, whichever methods you are using]
- Healy, K. 2018. *Data Visualization: A Practical Introduction* (Ch. 1). Princeton: Princeton University Press. [Seminar 9, quantitative projects]
- Saldaña, J. 2016. *The Coding Manual for Qualitative Researchers*, 3rd ed. (Ch. 1–2). London: SAGE. [Seminar 9, qualitative projects]
- Booth, W. C. et al. 2016. *The Craft of Research*, 4th ed. (Ch. 13–16). [Seminar 10]

General Recommended Reading

Gender and politics

- Paxton, P., Hughes, M. M. and Barnes, T. D. 2020. *Women, Politics, and Power: A Global Perspective*, 4th ed. Lanham: Rowman & Littlefield.
- Waylen, G., Celis, K., Kantola, J. and Weldon, S. L. (eds) 2013. *The Oxford Handbook of Gender and Politics*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Franceschet, S., Krook, M. L. and Tan, N. (eds) 2019. *The Palgrave Handbook of Women's Political Rights*. London: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Krook, M. L. and Childs, S. (eds) 2010. *Women, Gender, and Politics: A Reader*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Research methods

General

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